

James Basler, CTS, CSM

New York, NY

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RECENT EXPERIENCE:

Vivoh, January 2020 - Present, New York, NY

Lead Product Consultant for Enterprise Video Streaming applications

- Consulting on development and design of Vivoh's suite of video streaming products.
- Guiding product roadmaps, ensuring features and functionalities are enhanced for large scale enterprise deployments.
- Collaborating with cross-functional team at each phase of the product life cycle to facilitate effective and efficient product releases.

Morgan Stanley, June 2017 - January 2020, New York, NY

Vice President, Lead of Global Multimedia Engineering Team (responsible for firmwide video streaming and video conferencing)

Key Responsibilities

- Managed Global Multimedia Engineering Team comprised of video conferencing and video streaming engineers located in New York City and Budapest.
- Managed POC, development, and engineering relationships with vendors for video conferencing and video streaming products, including but not limited to Cisco, Vbrick Rev, Crestron, Qumu, Pexip, Zoom, and Logitech.
- Collaborated with vendors to conceive of and develop feature enhancements and better prioritize product roadmaps to meet the firm's requirements, improve end user experiences, and/or resolve non security related bugs or feature gaps.
- Researched and presented cutting edge video streaming, conferencing, and collaboration technologies and practices to impact and improve the vision and goals for each product space and their roadmap at the firm.
- Participated as lead technical SME in MSA negotiations for new video products/platforms. Participated in annual budgeting and contract renewal negotiations with implemented platforms' vendors/partners.
- Facilitated and coordinated cross-functional multimedia engineering projects using Agile methodology as Scrum Master, primarily using Jira and Kanban as project management and tracking tools. Collaborated with Product Management and Communications teams to drive effective product adoption and ensure efficient product releases/rollouts according to established timelines.
- Led weekly and monthly meetings with global end user technology stakeholders, coordinating scheduled changes with operations, presenting project status and technology roadmaps, and capturing feedback from end user partners from different divisions and departments across all regions globally (North America, EMEA, APAC and Japan).
- Collaborated with operations and engineering teams from various technology groups/departments, including but not limited to networking, proxy, storage, browser, web, QA, LDAP, core infrastructure, and security, to ensure effective implementation and rollout of video products and platforms.
- Responsible for working with the technology risk department, as IT product owner, for security review of all video conferencing and video streaming products, and in turn coordinating remediation/resolution of any discovered vulnerabilities, whether via internal configuration changes or working with the vendor to update associated products.
- Oversaw and managed software development lifecycle for various products and platforms, whether internally developed, vendor provided, or open source. Additionally tracked and maintained AV and Video Conferencing hardware production lifecycles.
- Managed sustaining engineering efforts for over 1,000 global video conferencing endpoints and associated global video conferencing infrastructure, including Cisco Expressway Edge/Core, Cisco TMS, and Cisco CMS.

Major Projects

- Oversaw the complex process to decommission the firm's legacy video streaming platform and in turn the successful implementation of a modern replacement platform with the application layer and storage in the cloud, and with hybrid media delivery, primarily on premises, for on demand and live (multicast and unicast) streaming for 85,000 global employees.
- Supervised the process to test, certify and implement modern Cisco Collaboration Endpoints into the firm's global video conferencing endpoint catalogue.
- Oversaw migration/upgrade of global video conferencing infrastructure from legacy Cisco VCS Control and Expressway systems to current Cisco Expressway Core and Edge systems.
- Created performance dashboards and alerting via Splunk for firmwide internal video streaming application, to allow for proactive monitoring and support from the Level 2 and Level 3 operations teams.
- Directed creation of updated documentation and training for operating video streaming and video conferencing products for Global AV Meeting/Event Operations teams, as well as troubleshooting and deployment documentation for Global Level 2 and Level 3 operations teams supporting associated infrastructure.
- Developed extensive documentation for driving end user adoption and improving the end user's experience using new video conferencing and video streaming platforms, both in huddle rooms & other conference rooms, as well as at the desktop.

IAC, September 2012 - June 2017, New York, NY
Senior Video Conferencing Engineer and Designer

Key Responsibilities

- Served as leader and global resource for IAC's 30+ businesses and their corporate offices for projects requiring sourcing and installation/integration of new audiovisual/video conferencing equipment or services.
- Researched, tested, presented, and advocated for new AV and VC equipment/technologies for future implementation at IAC, including attending and presenting at industry trade shows and conferences.
- Provided training, created documentation and developed resources for IAC and its businesses' IT support to better troubleshoot and solve AV and VC issues.
- Coordinated, managed, and assisted integrators in all installations and maintenance of IAC's NYC conference rooms and lobby, including but not limited to Crestron, Extron, Clearone, BiAmp, Prysm, and Christie products.
- Locally and remotely coordinated and managed all audiovisual and video conference setups for the office of the chairman, IAC's NYC based and visiting executives, including but not limited to IAC and Match Group Earnings Calls, and Board of Directors meetings for IAC, Match Group, Expedia Inc., and Coca Cola.
- Collaborated daily with IAC Networking, Systems, and IT teams to ensure firmwide video conferencing quality and stability.

Major Projects

- Led process to create and define global video conferencing standards and practices for all of IAC's businesses and its 5,000 employees, where previously, standardization across the various businesses' locations/offices did not exist.
- Acted as AV and video conferencing SME during the build out of Tinder's new offices in LA, working closely with Tinder IT and the project's AV integrator.
- Oversaw transition of IAC's video bridging services from BlueJeans to Ubiety, a cloud hosted CMS as a service, which resulted in a 70% year-over-year cost reduction, while doubling user adoption and usage rates of the previous service.
- Directed extensive AV and VC upgrades to IAC's board room with a \$380K project budget.
- Created new UX and UI for Crestron touch panel programming for the headquarters conference room upgrade projects.
- Designed new digital signage interface for the IAC lobby video wall using the Barco X2O media system. Oversaw and managed the content and operation of the X2O digital signage platform.

EDUCATION:

University of South Carolina, Columbia, SC
BA - Media Arts (Film & Video Production) 2008
GPA 3.9, Magna Cum Laude

RECENT INDUSTRY CERTIFICATIONS AND ENGAGEMENTS:

- Scrum Alliance CSM - Certified ScrumMaster
- Avixa CTS - Certified Technology Specialist
- AV/IT Leadership Summit 2018, Panelist - Session: "Lifecycle Planning for a Softer AV Ecosystem"
- Yamaha Enterprise Customer Advisory Board, 2017
- AV/IT Leadership Summit 2016, Keynote Speaker and Panelist - Keynote: "The Future of Video Now"
- Infocomm 2016, Panelist - Session: "State of UCC Lunch and Learn: End Users Speak Their Minds"

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE:

Alliance Bernstein, May 2011 - September 2012, New York, NY
Audio Visual Consultant

- Scheduled and coordinated daily AV and VC needs for reservations in 60+ conference rooms at company headquarters through a virtual EMS, and by liaising with internal and external clients.
- Oversaw the on-site upgrade of AV hardware and software by integrators for NYC conference rooms.
- Established and managed domestic and international video and audio conference connections both locally and remotely, using TMS, Codian, Crestron and AMX systems, Polycom Video Codecs, and MS LiveMeeting.
- Setup AV equipment and presentation media, and provided dedicated support for the events and meetings of all NYC based AB departments, executives and clients.
- Educated and trained users to be capable of self service conferencing setups and troubleshooting common meeting issues.
- Worked with content management systems and edited recorded video and audio content for internal and external distribution.

Central Park Group LLC, March 2011 – September 2012, New York NY
Freelance Graphic Designer and Video Producer

- Worked directly with the head of marketing, creating layouts and designs for print and web marketing material, directing and shooting video on location with fund managers, and in turn editing video for web and mobile marketing purposes.